



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Department of Weapons and Tactical Training
Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

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Department of Weapons and Tactical Training
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A. INTRODUCTION

The use of firearms for operational duties is critical in ensuring police officers safety and the safety of members of the public. The Jamaica Constabulary Force recognize the need to properly quip and maintain officers skills and knowledge to safely use, care and handle firearms whilst on and off duty. The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure is to solidify the content of the Firearm Requalification Training programme adapted by the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) and to standardize roles and responsibilities of trainers.

B. DRESS CODE

- B.1 All police officers attending Firearm Requalification Training must be properly attired reflecting their dress code for duty on a daily basis:
- a. Uniform personnel must be attired in the number one uniform or denim with all the JCF insignias.
 - b. Detectives should be attired in their working dress or dark colour T-shirt and jeans.
 - c. Close protection officers must be attired in business suit.
 - d. Specialist teams such as SWAT must be attired in full battle order.
- B.1.2 Participants who are not appropriately attired will not be accepted on the training programme, for instance, being attired in uniforms or other clothing that expose private body parts, or that fits the body closely so that it exposes the private parts. Also, the following attires are strictly prohibited:
- a. Part uniform
 - b. Uniform and accoutrements not approved by the JCF.
 - c. Marina or vest
 - d. Shorts
 - e. Slippers
 - f. Shoes that does not cover the top of the feet.

C. REGISTRATION

- C.1. The Firearm Requalification Training should start at 8:30am each morning with the registration of all the police officers that reported for training. This includes a list of police officers' names, rank, regulation numbers, divisions and the type of firearm(s) that they will use during training.
- C.1.1. Participants must present their JCF identification card and firearm booklet for inspection by the Sub officer in charge of the Firearm Requalification Training or his/her designate. This must be done in order to properly identify the persons as JCF members and to determine their training needs. Where a member does not have his identification card, but can be properly identified by another member of the JCF, he may be permitted.
- C.1.2. Where an officer is not in possession of a firearm certification booklet due to it being lost; destroyed or lack of issuance, checks must be made at DWTT General Office to determine the member's certification status. In the case of lost or destroyed firearm certification booklets the member must be advised to submit a report to his/her Divisional Commander outlining the circumstances. The endorsed report should be sent to the Commanding officer - DWTT who will ensure that a certification booklet is prepared and delivered to the member. If it is a case of lack of issuance, then one must be prepared and issued under signature to the member concerned at the successful completion of the training.
- C.1.3. An entry of all police officers attending firearms training must be recorded in the DWTT station diary as reported for and commenced 'Firearm Requalification Training' under the caption 'Firearm Requalification Training.' This goes for all such training whether being conducted on the NPCJ Campus or at other designated locations.
- C.1.4. Officers who attend firearm requalification training after the JCF Human Rights and Police Use of Force and Firearms Policy's lecture should **NOT** be accepted on the programme.
- C.1.5. The decision to not accepted police officers on the training programme at the time of registration or later, notwithstanding paragraphs A.1.2 and B.1.3 above, rest with the following persons:
- ACP Training
 - Commanding Officer for DWTT
 - Sub-officer in charge of DTTT

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

- Any other sub-officer so authorized by the above mentioned officers and sub-officer.

D. TRAINING CONTENT

D.1. Lectures:

All participants who attend firearm requalification training must be lectured on the following subjects for no less than forty-five minutes each:

- Human Rights
- Police Use of Force
- Firearm Safe Use, Care and Handling

D.1.1 The firearm lectures should be centered on the JCF Standard issued firearms. In instances where a request is made in writing for a member of the JCF to be trained with privately owned firearm for use on duty, the affected member must be trained with the specific firearm. Also, the training must include the characteristics and operation of the firearm. The JCF Standard issue firearms are listed below:

- i. Smith & Wesson .38 Revolver
- ii. Browning (BDA) .380 pistol
- iii. Beretta 84FS Cheetah .380 Pistol
- iv. Glock 17 9mm Pistol
- v. Glock 19 9mm Pistol
- vi. Glock 18c 9mm Pistol
- vii. Browning Hi-Power Pistol (BSA)
- viii. Browning Hi-Power Pistol (BDA)
- ix. Remington Model 870 12gauge Shotgun
- x. Colt Submachine Gun
- xi. M16 Assault Rifle

D.2. Live Firing Activities:

D.2.1. All participants are required to do at least one live practice shoot and the Assessment Shoot with the designated firearm(s) during the training. The practice shoots will develop the officer's knowledge and firing skills with the firearm(s). It will also boost their confidence and gives them a fair chance to demonstrate the required level of competence with the each firearm.

D.2.2. Participants are required to zero the M16 Assault Rifle and the Colt Submachine Gun
JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

before the practice and assessment exercises. They should be issued with ten (10) rounds per weapon for this purpose.

D.2.3 The firearm training must be conducted with regards to the operation of each firearm: loading and unloading method; cocking and de-cocking method; field stripping procedures as well as firing techniques.

D.2.4. All range safety infringement warrants disqualification from the range, see Range Standing Orders.

D.2.5. Participants are scored and allowed to patch out the targets at the end of each shoot. This must be done only when the range is safe, on instruction of the Range Commanding Office (RCO) or Firing line Officer (FLO) who will give instructions DEAD RANGE. at this time all weapons must holstered or grounded, see Range Standing Orders.

D.2.6. At the end of all live firing the participants must field strip and cleaning the firearm(s) that they used during the training. This exercise must be supervised by a coach and each participant assessed on their ability to clean and maintain the firearm(s) (see Assessment Criteria and Range Standing Order).

D.3 Type of Shoots

D.3.1 The composition of the practice and assessment shoots for pistols and revolvers is outlined below:

FIRST PRACTICE SHOOT (30rds.)			
DIST	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
7m	Start: weapon holstered.	2	n/a
	Fire 5 rounds standing with both hands, scan		
3m	Start: hands at the surrender position.	2	n/a
	Strong hand draw from holster, fire two rounds standing, then scan and holster.		
3m		2	n/a
	Strong hand draw and switch to weak hand, fire two rounds, then scan and holster.		
	Start: hands at the side.	2	n/a
5m	Strong hand draw from holster and fire one round standing and one round kneeling.	2	n/a
5m	Strong hand draw and switch to weak hand, fire one round		

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

	standing and one round kneeling.		
	Start: weapon in both hands at 45 ⁰ to shooter body.		
7m	Shout drop the weapon, twice, fire one round standing and one round kneeling, and then returned to the 45 ⁰ position.	2	n/a
	TAKE SCORES AND PATCH		

SECOND PRACTICE SHOOT (10 rds.)			
DIST	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
	Start: hands at the side.		
3m	Strong hand draw from holster, fire two rounds at Target A , then scan and holster.	1	4 sec.
3m & 5m	Strong hand draw, fire two rounds on Target-A and two rounds on Target-B , then scan and holster.	1	6 sec.
	Start: weapon in both hands at 45 ⁰ to shooter body.		
5m & 7m	Strong hand draw, fire two rounds on Target-B and two rounds on Target-C , then scan and holster.	1	10 sec.
	TAKE SCORES AND PATCH		

ASSESSMENT SHOOT (10 rds.)			
DIST	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
	Start: hands at the side.		
3m	Strong hand draw from holster, fire two rounds at Target A , then scan and holster.	1	4 sec.
3m & 5m	Strong hand draw, fire two rounds on Target-A and two rounds on Target-B , then scan and holster.	1	6 sec.
	Start: weapon in both hands at 45 ⁰ to shooter body.		
5m & 7m	Strong hand draw, fire two rounds on Target-B and two rounds on Target-C , then scan and holster.	1	10 sec.
	TAKE SCORES AND PATCH		

D.3.2. The composition of the practice and assessment shoots for the Colt Submachine Gun is outlined below:

PRACTICE SHOOT (30 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
10m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire six rounds, apply safety, scan and position as at start.		
10m	Start: weapon position at the 45 ⁰ turn left and right alternately.	1	4 sec
	Fire three rounds standing, apply safety, scan and reposition		

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

	weapon at 45 ⁰ .		
20m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	2	10 sec
	Fire two rounds standing and two rounds kneeling; apply safety and scan.		
30m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire ten rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.			

ASSESSMENT SHOOT (20 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
10m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire five rounds, apply safety, scan and position as at start.		
10m	Start: Face target with weapon position at the 45 ⁰ .	1	4 sec
	Fire three rounds standing, apply safety, scan and reposition weapon at 45 ⁰ . Unload at the end of shoot.		
20m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	2	10 sec
	Fire two rounds standing and two rounds kneeling; apply safety and scan.		
30m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire four rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.			

D.3.3. The composition of the practice and assessment shoots for the M16 assault rifle is outlined below:

PRACTICE SHOOT (25 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
25m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire five rounds standing with weak hand, apply safety, scan and position as at start.		
m	Start: weapon position at the 45 ⁰ turn left and right alternately.	1	4 sec
	Fire three rounds from burst, apply safety, scan and reposition weapon at 45 ⁰ .		
25m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire one round standing and three rounds kneeling; apply safety and scan.		
25m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire six rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
50m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire five rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.			

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

ASSESSMENT SHOOT (25 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
10m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire four rounds standing, apply safety, scan and position as at start.		
10m	Start: weapon position at the 45 ⁰ turn left and right alternately.	1	4 sec
	Fire three rounds from burst, apply safety, scan and reposition weapon at 45 ⁰ .		
25m	Start: weapon at the take control position.	1	n/a
	Fire one round standing and three rounds kneeling; apply safety and scan.		
25m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire six rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
50m	Start: Shooter in the prone position and weapon in hand.	1	n/a
	Fire five rounds, apply safety, scan and unload.		
TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.			

D.3.4. The composition of the practice and assessment shoots for the M16 assault rifle is outlined below:

ASSESSMENT SHOOT (25 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
	Start: weapon at the take control position.		
	Fire 10 rounds deliberate		
	Start:		
	Start:		
	Start:		
	Start:		
TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.			

ASSESSMENT SHOOT (25 rds.)			
DIST.	EXERCISE	DONE	TIME
	Start:		
	Start:		
	Start:		

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

	Start:		
	Start:		
	TAKE SCORES AND PATCH AT EACH DIST.		

D.3.4. at the end of all live firing the participants must field strip and cleaning of firearms that they use during the training. This exercise will be supervised and each participant assessed.

E.4. ASSESSMENT

E.4.1. Participants will be assessed using a practical shooting test in which they are required to score a minimum of 60% and demonstrate safe weapon handling. Safe weapon handling is the proper handling of the firearm with regards to the participant's culminating knowledge of the following:

- a) Firearm safety rules
- b) Properly grip firearm
- c) Loading and unloading
- d) Identify and remedying system stoppages
- e) Stable shooting stance
- f) Field stripping and clean
- g) Function check

E.4.2 Assessment Criteria

i. Demonstrates safety firearm handling during assessment

Pass: Always handles firearm safely – muzzle always pointed in a safe direction and finger always out of the trigger guard, except when firing; always follow instruction from the RCO or coach.

Fail: Fails to handle firearm safely – muzzle occasionally pointed in unsafe direction; finger enters trigger guard when not intending firer; fails to follow directions given by the RCO or coach.

ii. Properly grip firearm

Pass: Usually grips weapon properly while in holster – does not look away from area of responsibility while gripping firearm in holster; grip usually support the weapon and does not obstruct the trigger finger or releases the magazine during firing.

Fail: Does not properly grip weapon while in holster – takes eyes off area of responsibility to look towards weapon; frequently re-grips weapon before firing; grip does not properly support the weapon, grip often obstructs the trigger finger or usually releases the magazine.

iii. Properly load and unload firearm

Pass: Always point weapon in a safe direction and finger off trigger when loading or unloading; usually aware of current state of ammunition supply; reload firearm in smooth and efficient manner without attempting to fire on an empty chamber

Fail: Occasionally point weapon in an unsafe direction or place finger inside of the trigger while loading or unloading; often fails to recognize when chamber is empty; reloading weapon in an awkward and inefficient manner.

iv. Aggressively identify and remedy system stoppages

Pass: Always reactively recognizes system stoppages; always able to clear stoppages quickly and efficiently and resume firing, if necessary.

Fail: Fail to reactively recognize system stoppages; not able to reactively clear stoppages in an efficient manner.

v. Field strip weapon

Pass: Always prove that the weapon is unloaded prior to disassembling; usually disassemble weapon according to the proper takedown procedure; properly clean and maintain weapon;

Fail: Seldom proved weapon is unloaded before disassembling; cannot disassemble the weapon; does not cleaning and maintain the weapon properly for use;

vi. Function check

Pass: Effectively function check the weapon after reassembling – assess the systematic workings of the slide or bolt, trigger mechanism, slide lock, slide stop release lever, magazine catch and magazine release lever or button.

Fail: Does not conduct a thorough function check of the weapon to ensure its workability.

E.4.2. All participants must demonstrate safe weapon handling before live firing. If in the opinion of the instructor a participant is demonstrating very poor weapon handling that would put the instructors and other participants at risk, he must recommend that he/she receive remedial training.

F. QUALIFICATION TRAINING

F.1. The following persons should do the qualification training if they attend the Firearm Requalification Course:

- Police officers who have not done firearm recertification training within the last five year
- Police officer who were on suspension or interdiction for over two years
- Police officers who have not been qualified with the weapon for which the training is requested.

F.2. This training should encompass the Firearm Qualifications Standards and last for a minimum of two days as outline below:

➤ **Day one**

- Human Rights Lecture
- Police Use of Force Lecture
- Firearm Lecture
- Weapon Drills
 - Load and unloading of magazine
 - Loading and unloading of weapons
 - Proper use of Clearing Pit
 - Present weapon
- Practice Shoots (1st and 2nd Shoot)

➤ **Day two**

- Firearm Assimilation Training (Optional)
- Practice Shoots and Assessment (3rd, 4th and Qualification)

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

G. RE-SHOOT

- G.1. If a participant failed the assessment shoot, he/she is entitled to a reshoot the same day providing that the reason for failing is not due to disqualification or his/her consistent failure to properly execute instructions. In all instances where a participant failed the assessment, further training must be given before a reshoot is offered. It might not be possible to conduct a reshoot on the same day if the training is impacted by the following:
- Poor weather conditions that will affect the shooter's ability to shoot accurately or which poses a safety hazard
 - The time does not allow for further training
 - In adequate resources.
 - The participant expressed or demonstrates an inability to focus during the training.
- G.2. Instructors should determine the problem(s) which cause the participant to fail and address the issues before offering a reshoot: For example, poor trigger control, inconsistent sight alignment or aim etc.

H. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

H.1. Course Coordinator:

- H.1.2 A sub-officer must be assigned as the Firearm Requalification Course coordinator and will have the responsibility for the following:
- a) Secure the training aids and resources needed for the successful completion of the course
 - b) Identification and selection of suitable training area.
 - c) Briefing, tasking and debriefing of team members
 - d) Ensure that participants are welcomed and the course outlined to them.
 - e) Command the Range during live firing
 - f) Update firearm certification booklet.
 - g) Ensure that all books, logs and registers are properly maintained.
 - h) Report all major incidents within 24 hours.
 - i) Submit a formal report to the sub-officer in-charge of Firearm Training at DWTT outlining the following:
 - I. Type of training
 - II. Start time and ending time of the training
 - III. Team that conducted the training

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

- IV. Training venue
- V. Number of police officers trained
- VI. Course content
- VII. Breakdown of divisions trained
- VIII. Breakdown of weapons used
- IX. Breakdown of rounds used
- X. Injuries or illness
- XI. Damage or missing government properties
- XII. Strengths and weaknesses
- XIII. Recommendation(s)

H.2. Lecturer

H.2.1 The lecturers will deliver the theoretical aspects of the training and are responsible for the following:

- I. Secure training aids
- II. Develop structured lesson plans and presentations that will engage the participants
- III. Assess the participants knowledge and weapon handling skills

H.3 Administration Officer (AO)

H.3.1 The AO will provide administrative support to the Course Coordinator and will carry out the following tasks:

- I. Register participants
- II. Record all relevant incidents and report to the Course Coordinator in a timely manner
- III. Conduct range administration duties (see Range Standing Orders)

H.4 Range Tasks

H.4.1. The range tasks include a variety of functions that are performed on the range for proper command and control of the range activities (see Range Standing Orders).

I. Resources and Training Aids

I.1 To conduct this course the following resources and training aids will be used to improve the quality and effectiveness of the training programme:

JCF Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Firearm Requalification Standard Operating Procedures

- Ambulance
- Service vehicle
- Firearms
- An assortment of rounds
- Ear protectors
- Spectacles
- Range
- B-27 Targets
- Classroom with fixtures
- Multimedia System
- Load hailer
- Flipchart
- Markers
- Video clips
- Igloo
- Toiletries